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THE MEDIATING ROLE OF CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE BETWEEN DIGITAL MARKETING STRATEGIES AND SUPPLY CHAIN PERFORMANCE IN E-COMMERCE FIRMS

Gaurinandan Kashyap - MBA IV
Shubham Singh Chandel - Assistant Professor

Faculty of Commerce and Management, Kalinga University, Raipur (C.G.)

ABSTRACT:

With the continuous expansion of online business platforms, companies now approach marketing in a different way, using digital channels more strategically, while also restructuring their supply chain systems to improve coordination and efficiency. In this developing landscape, Customer experience now acts as a major connection point between what organizations communicate digitally and how efficiently their supply chains deliver on those promises. This study examines how customer experience acts as an intermediate factor connecting digital marketing strategies with the performance of supply chains in e-commerce companies. The research follows a descriptive approach and makes use of information collected from both original sources and existing data. Original data was collected with the help of a systematic questionnaire developed using Google Forms. questionnaire distributed among 102 respondents including students, working professionals, and business owners. The research also relied on information taken from earlier studies and documented sources. academic journals, corporate reports, and previously published research. The analysis shows that the use of digital marketing methods particularly through social media strongly influence customer experience, and that a superior customer experience positively impacts supply chain performance by improving delivery perception, reducing dissatisfaction, and building buyer trust.

The paper concludes that e-commerce firms must treat customer experience not simply as a marketing outcome but as a strategic mediator that connects online communication with operational excellence. Organizations that invest in seamless, personalized, and transparent There is a greater possibility that customers will achieve stronger supply chain performance and sustained competitive advantage.

Keywords: Digital Marketing, Customer Experience, Supply Chain Performance, E-Commerce, Mediating Role, Consumer Satisfaction

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study

The e-commerce industry has grown at an exceptional pace over the past decade, propelled by advances in digital technology, widespread internet penetration, and transforming consumer behaviour. E-commerce sales globally surpassed five trillion US dollars in 2022 and it is expected to keep increasing at a steady yearly rate of more than 10% until 2027.. (Global e-commerce market will be worth \$9.3 trillion by 2027, forecasts Global Data, 2023) The fast growth has pushed e-commerce firms to focus on gaining and retaining customers through digital marketing, while also fulfilling these commitments through well-managed supply chains.

E-commerce businesses use different digital marketing methods, one of which is search engine optimization, promotion through social media platforms and marketing via email, content marketing, content creator partnerships, as well as personalized advertising powered by artificial intelligence and big data analytics. As evidenced by this study, social media is the dominant channel through which consumers discover and engage with e-commerce brands, as a majority (74%) reported that they mainly see e-commerce advertisements on social media. (The State of Digital Marketing in India 2024-25, n.d.)

This is where customer experience serves a pivotal role. Customer experience in e-commerce refers to the totality of interactions a customer has with a brand across the entire purchase journey from the first digital touchpoint through to post-delivery service. (Mittameedi et al., 2025) A positive customer experience not merely increases the chance of repeat purchases and word-of-mouth referrals but also produces the kind of predictable, loyal demand that supply chains need to operate efficiently. (Online, 2023)

1.2 Research Problem

E-commerce firms frequently invest heavily in digital marketing strategies without completely considering how those strategies shape customer expectations and, consequently, how those expectations place demands on the supply chain. When customer experience is ignored as a mediating variable, organizations often find themselves in a situation where excellent marketing creates demand that the supply chain cannot fulfil, leading to customer dissatisfaction, high return rates, and harm to reputation. (Ngo et al., 2025) This study intends to examine and formally establish how customer experience influences the relationship between digital marketing and supply chain efficiency..

1.3 Objectives of the Study

The objectives of this research are as follows:

- To understand the different digital marketing approaches adopted by e-commerce businesses and their scope.
- To evaluate different parts of customer experience in the context of online retail.
- To understand the relationship between digital marketing efforts and supply chain outcomes.
- To examine the role played by customer experience between marketing efforts and supply chain performance.
- To provide strategic recommendations for e-commerce firms trying to optimize this three-way relationship

1.4 Scope and Importance of the Study

This study is significant for several reasons. First, it addresses a gap in the academic literature by formally examining customer experience as a mediator between digital marketing and supply chain performance. Second, it offers useful insights for e-commerce managers who seek to coordinate their marketing communication with their operational capacities. Third, it enhances the growing body of research on integrated business strategy in digital environments, with particular relevance to the Indian e-commerce context.

The scope of the study concentrates on e-commerce consumers and professionals in India, with particular relevance to young adult digital consumers between the ages of 18 and 35 who represent the most active segment of the Indian online shopping population.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW WITH RESEARCH GAP

Digital marketing has moved from being a supporting communication method to becoming a key factor in attracting and retaining customers in the e-commerce sector. According to Kotler and Keller (2016), digital marketing refers to the use of online channels to promote products and services, interact with customers, and strengthen brand value. In the context of e-commerce, these strategies are highly effective as they enable businesses to target specific customer groups, monitor performance instantly, and provide personalized experiences on a large scale..

Chaffey and Ellis-Chadwick (2019) emphasized – that the success level of digital marketing activities in e-commerce depends beyond reach and engagement, it also depends on how well customer expectations are communicated. When digital marketing overpromises advertising next-day delivery that the supply chain cannot support, for example the resulting gap amid expectation and reality creates a damaging customer experience that erodes loyalty and increases returns.

Customer experience is now one of the most widely discussed topics in both academic studies and practical business discussions related to e-commerce. Lemon and Verhoef (2016) explained customer experience as a multi-dimensional concept that includes customers' thoughts, feelings, actions, sensory perceptions, and social responses during their interactions with a company throughout the entire customer journey. Many studies have found that customer experience strongly influences customer loyalty, repeat buying behaviour, and net promoter scores.

Supply chain performance in e-commerce refers to the efficiency, responsiveness, as well as reliability with which an e-commerce firm fulfils customer orders, manages inventory, coordinates logistics partners, and handles returns. Chopra and Meindl (2016) defined supply chain performance among several dimensions including efficiency, responsiveness, reliability, and flexibility. In e-commerce, supply chain performance is particularly critical because the supply chain is the physical manifestation of the brand promise made through digital marketing.

The service-profit chain model developed by Heskett et al. (1994) provides the theoretical basis to analyze how digital marketing approaches drive customer experience quality, which in turn drives the behavioural patterns purchasing frequency, order predictability, return rates that determine supply chain performance.

Research Gap

Despite the extensive literature on digital marketing, customer experience, and supply chain management individually, very little research has focused on the relationship between these three elements. between these constructs in an integrated framework. Most research treats digital marketing and supply chain management as separate organizational functions, overlooking the important part played by customer experience in linking the two. Furthermore, existing research on e-commerce performance tends to focus on either marketing outcomes or operational metrics, rarely examining how improvements in customer experience simultaneously improve both. This study intends to fill this gap via formally positioning customer experience as the mediating connection among digital marketing methods and supply chain performance in e-commerce firms.

3. DATA COLLECTION AND RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Research Design

This study applies a descriptive framework to explore the role of customer experience between digital marketing activities and supply chain performance in e-commerce firms. Descriptive research is appropriate here because it permits the systematic gathering and examination of data about a current phenomenon lacking manipulating variables. The primary objective is to explain and understand how three main factors are connected in real consumer situations.

3.2 Research Approach

A research approach focused on statistical and numerical analysis was used, involving the collection of numerical data through a standardized questionnaire. This approach provides the measurement of respondent perceptions and attitudes in a standardized, comparable format, supporting to find patterns and connections among the three main variables of the study.

3.3 Data Sources

Primary information was gathered using a structured Google Forms questionnaire distributed among 102 respondents, including students, working professionals, and business owners with direct experience of digital commerce platforms. The questionnaire was created to collect perceptions related to digital marketing effectiveness, customer experience quality, and supply chain performance outcomes.

Secondary information was collected from academic journals, e-commerce sector reports, textbooks on supply chain management and digital marketing, and previously published research on customer experience and organizational performance.

3.4 Sampling Technique

Respondents were selected using convenience sampling, as this method is easy to use and practical and efficiency in collecting data from accessible and knowledgeable participants. While this limits the generalizability of the findings, it is appropriate for an exploratory descriptive study of this nature.

3.5 Sample Size

A total of 102 respondents participated in the study. The sample included e-commerce consumers from diverse backgrounds, with a predominant representation of young adults in the 18-25 age group, consistent with basic details about the respondents of the most active online shopping population in India.

3.6 Data Collection Instrument

A detailed questionnaire consisting of 22 carefully designed questions acted as the key tool for collecting data. The questionnaire was structured based on three main areas thematic sections corresponding to the three key constructs: digital marketing strategies, customer experience, and supply chain performance. Both Likert-scale and rating-scale questions were used to capture a comprehensive picture of consumer perceptions.

3.7 Data Analysis Techniques

The data was examined using basic statistical methods such as frequency distribution and percentage analysis. These methods allowed for the identification of common perceptions and trends across the respondent group. The results are shown in table format for clarity and straightforwardness of interpretation.

3.8 Conceptual Research Model

The framework of this study proposes that digital marketing methods function as the independent variable, while supply chain performance is treated as the dependent variable, and customer experience serves as the connecting factor between them. It explains that digital marketing influences customer expectations and behaviour, which then affects the demands placed on the supply chain. The overall quality of customer experience plays an important role in determining how strong and in which direction this relationship develops.

Model: Electronic marketing strategies → Customer Experience → Supply Chain Performance
4. Analysis of Questionnaire Responses

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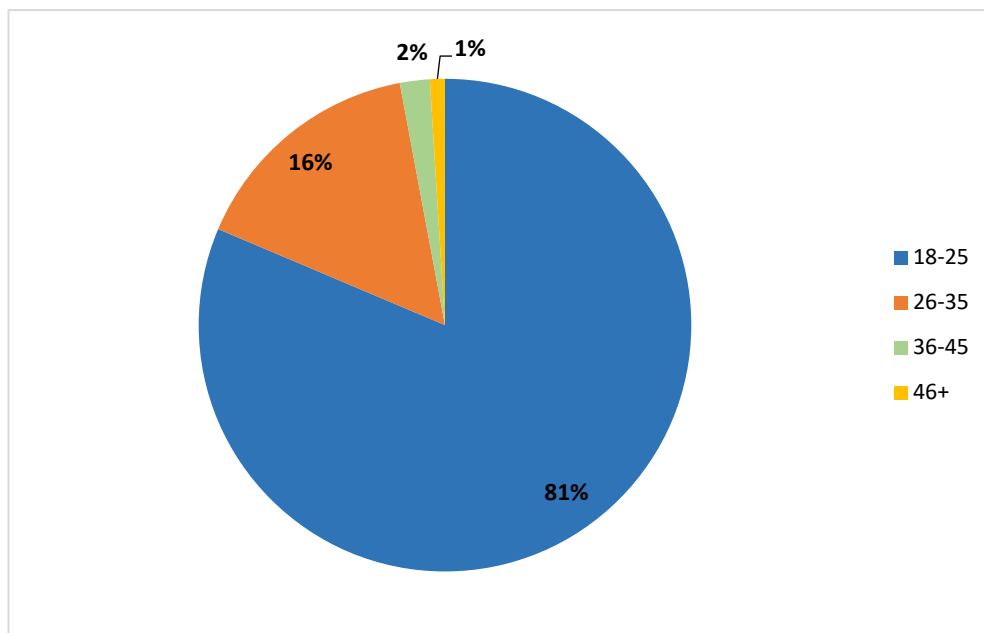
4.1 Analysis of Data and Results

1. What is your age group?

: Age Group Distribution of Respondents

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
18-25	83	81%
26-35	16	16%
36-45	2	2%
46+	1	1%

Total	102	100%
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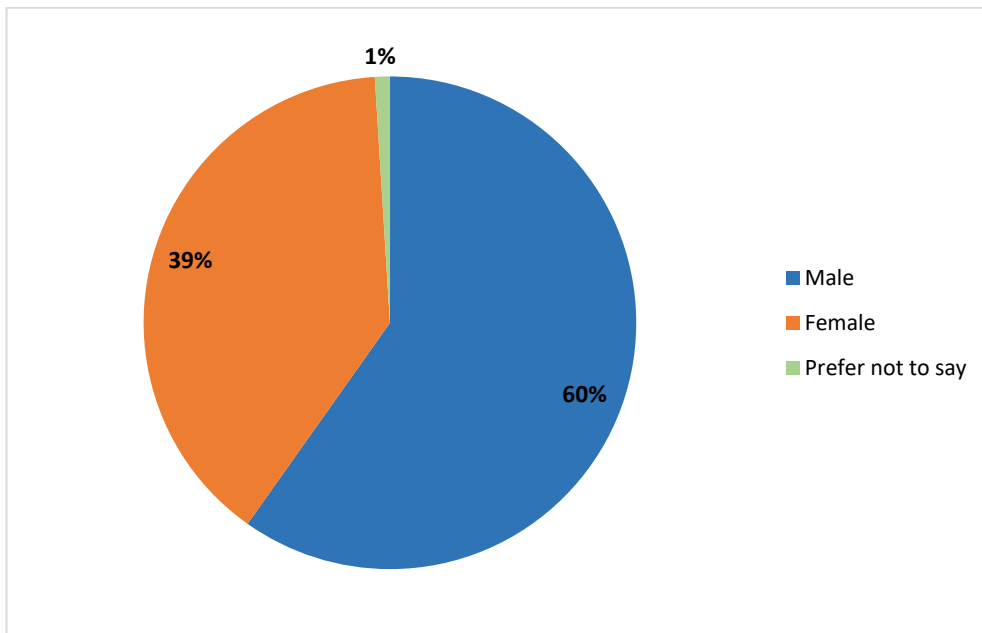


Interpretation: Out of 102 respondents, the majority (81%) belong to the 18-25 age group, reflecting strong participation from young digital consumers. The 26-35 age group accounts for 16%, while those above 35 represent only 3% within the selected respondents. This age pattern shows that the study predominantly captures the perspective of young, digitally active consumers.

2. What is your gender?

Gender Distribution of Respondents

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Male	61	60%
Female	40	39%
Prefer not to say	1	1%
Total	102	100%

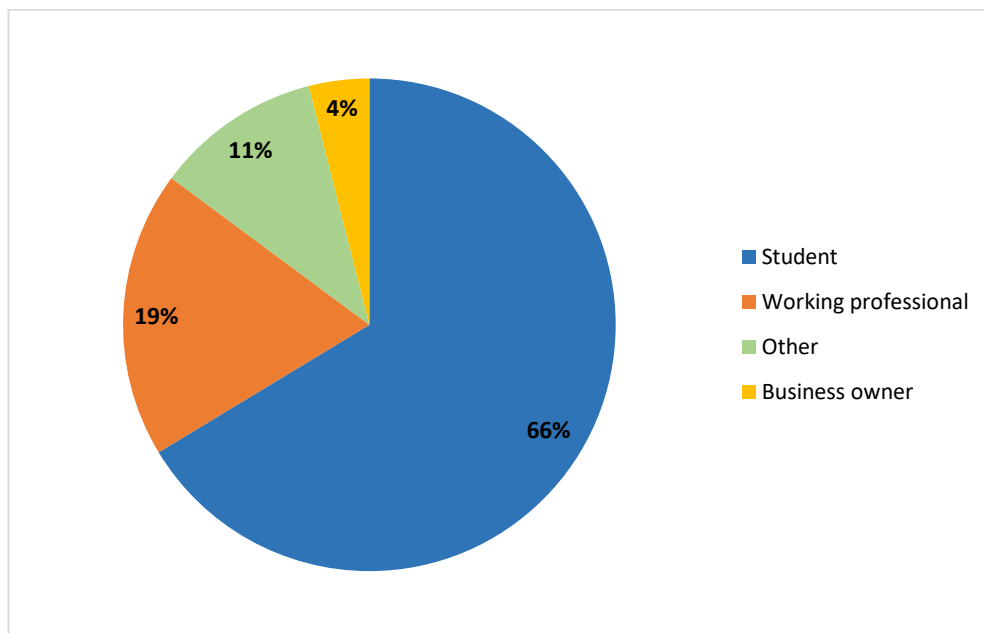


Interpretation: 60% of respondents are male, 39% are female, and 1% preferred not to disclose their gender. The reasonable gender balance in the sample helps ensure that the results represent perspectives from across the gender spectrum, though male respondents show a marginally higher preference to be represented in this study.

3. What is your occupation?

Occupation of Respondents

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Student	67	66%
Working professional	19	19%
Other	11	11%
Business owner	4	4%
Total	101	100%

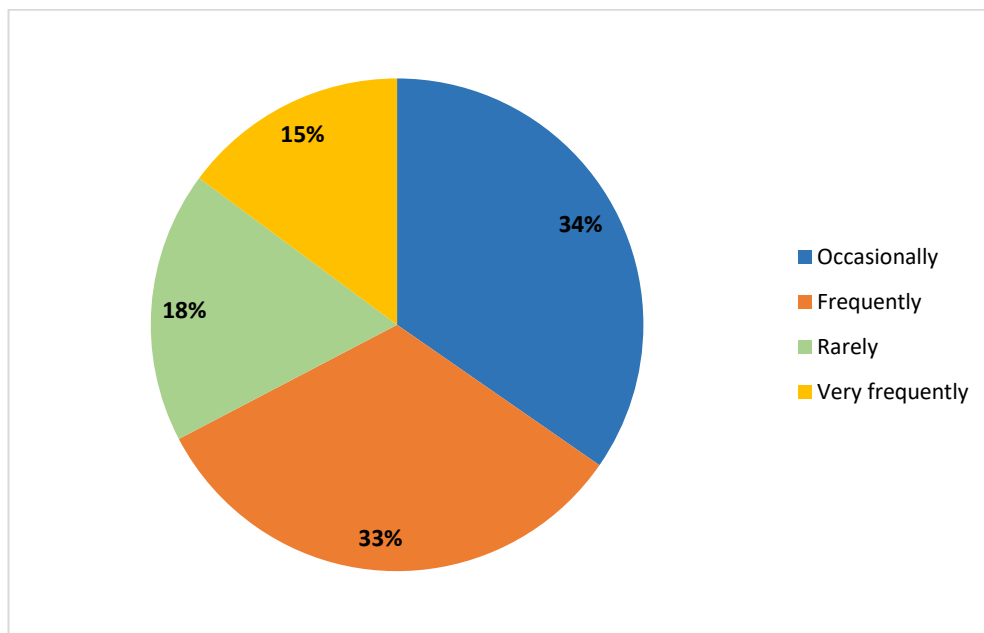


Interpretation: Students form the largest respondent group at 65%, followed by working professionals at 18% and others at 11%. Business owners account for 4%. The strong presence of students is in line with the age distribution and reflects the heavy reliance of young consumers on internet-based platforms for searching information and buying products.

4. How often do you shop online?

Online Shopping Frequency

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Occasionally	35	35%
Frequently	33	33%
Rarely	18	18%
Very frequently	15	15%
Total	101	100%

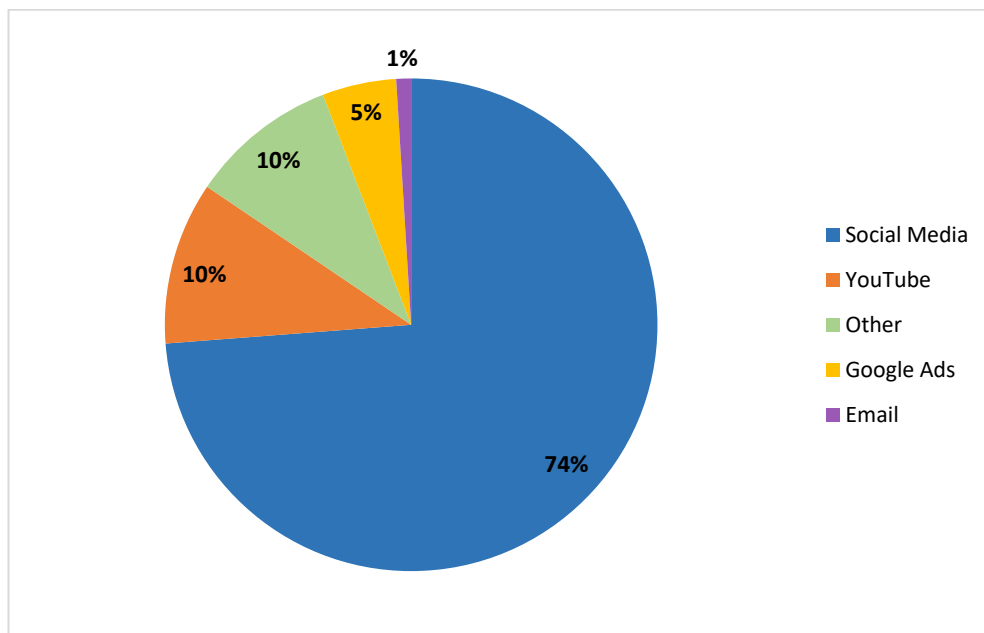


Interpretation: 35% of respondents shop online occasionally, while 33% do so frequently and 15% very frequently. Together, 48% shop online at least frequently, indicating a strong and active e-commerce consumer base. Only 18% shop rarely, suggesting that the use of online channels for shopping has become well integrated into the purchasing behavior of most respondents.

5. Where do you usually see ads of e-commerce products?

Primary Source of E-Commerce Advertisements

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Social media	76	74%
YouTube	11	11%
Other	10	10%
Google Ads	5	5%
Email	1	1%
Total	103	100%

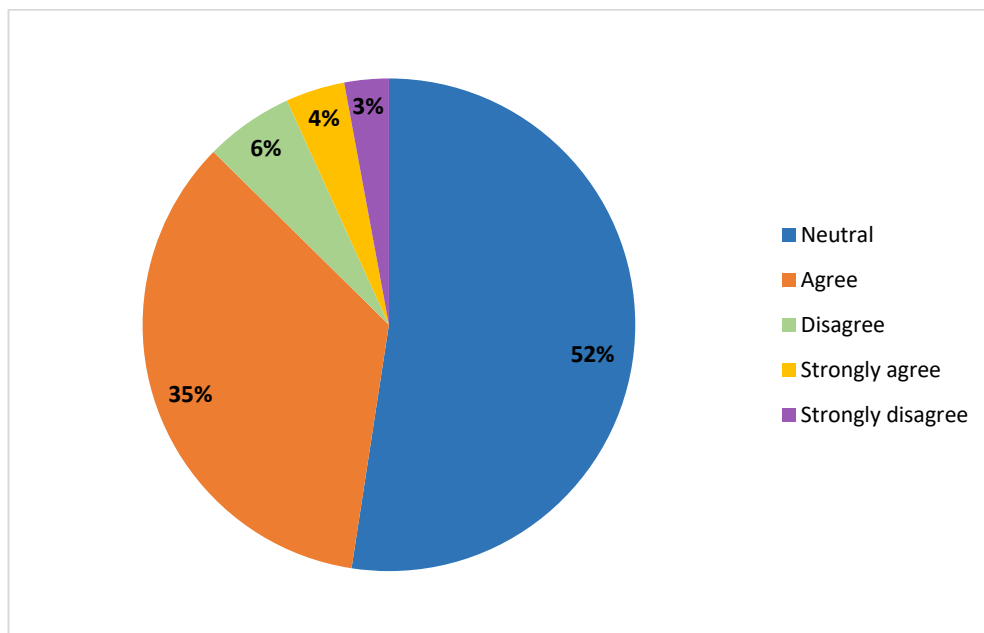


Interpretation: Social media platforms play a major role overwhelmingly the most popular source of e-commerce advertisements, cited by 74% of respondents. YouTube follows at 11%, with other sources and Google Ads accounting for 10% and 5% respectively. This finding strongly confirms the dominance of for e-commerce brands targeting young consumers.

6. Do digital ads influence your purchase decision?

Influence of Digital Ads on Purchase Decisions

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Neutral	54	52%
Agree	36	35%
Disagree	6	6%
Strongly agree	4	4%
Strongly disagree	3	3%
Total	103	100%

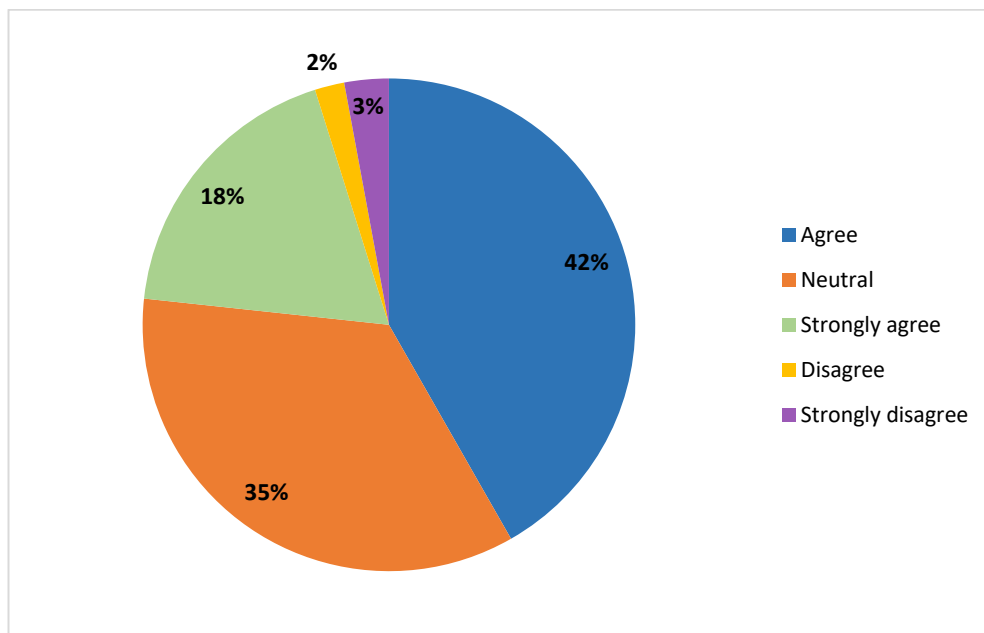


Interpretation: 52% of participants showed no strong opinion about whether digital ads impact their purchase choices, with 39% agreeing or strongly agreeing. Only 9% disagreed or strongly disagreed. The high neutral response suggests that digital advertising has a subtle rather than direct influence on purchasing behavior, working through brand recall and familiarity rather than immediate conversion.

7. Are personalized recommendations helpful?

Perception of Personalized Recommendations

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	43	42%
Neutral	36	35%
Strongly agree	19	18%
Disagree	2	2%
Strongly disagree	3	3%
Total	103	100%

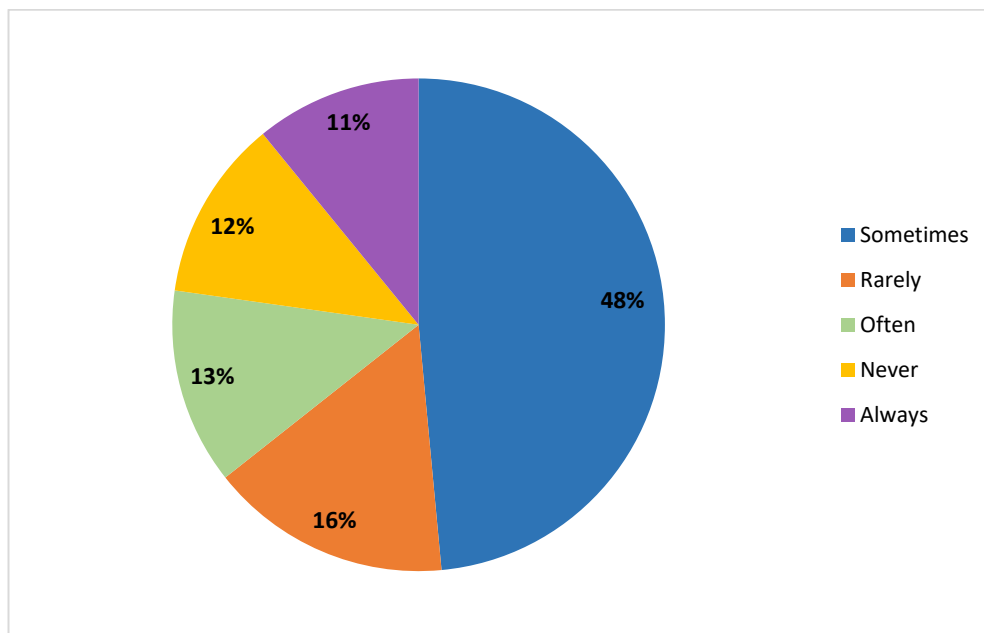


Interpretation: 60% of respondents agreed or strongly agreed that personalized recommendations are helpful, while 35% were neutral. Only 5% disagreed. This finding supports the value of AI-driven personalization in e-commerce digital marketing strategies and suggests that a majority of consumers respond positively to tailored product suggestions.

8. How often do you click on e-commerce ads?

Frequency of Clicking on E-Commerce Ads

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Sometimes	49	49%
Rarely	16	16%
Often	13	13%
Never	12	12%
Always	11	11%
Total	101	100%

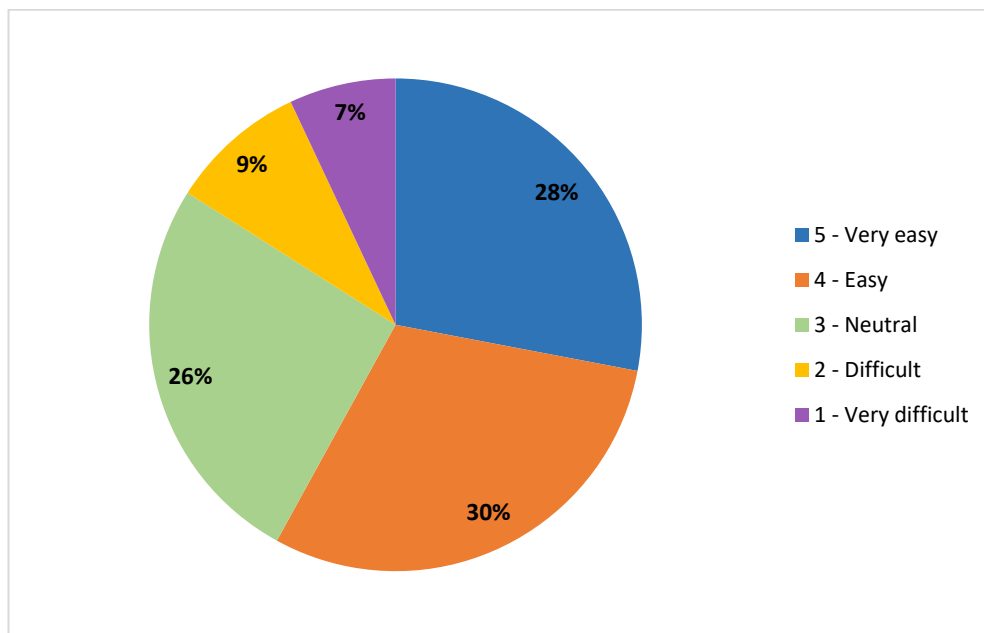


Interpretation: 49% of respondents click on e-commerce ads sometimes, and 13% click often or always. Combined, 73% engage with ads at least occasionally, which validates the effectiveness of digital advertising in driving consumer interaction. Only 12% never click on ads, indicating a broadly receptive audience for digital marketing campaigns.

9. How easy is the website/app to use?

Website/App Ease of Use Rating

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
5 - Very easy	28	28%
4 - Easy	30	30%
3 - Neutral	26	26%
2 - Difficult	9	9%
1 - Very difficult	7	7%
Total	100	100%

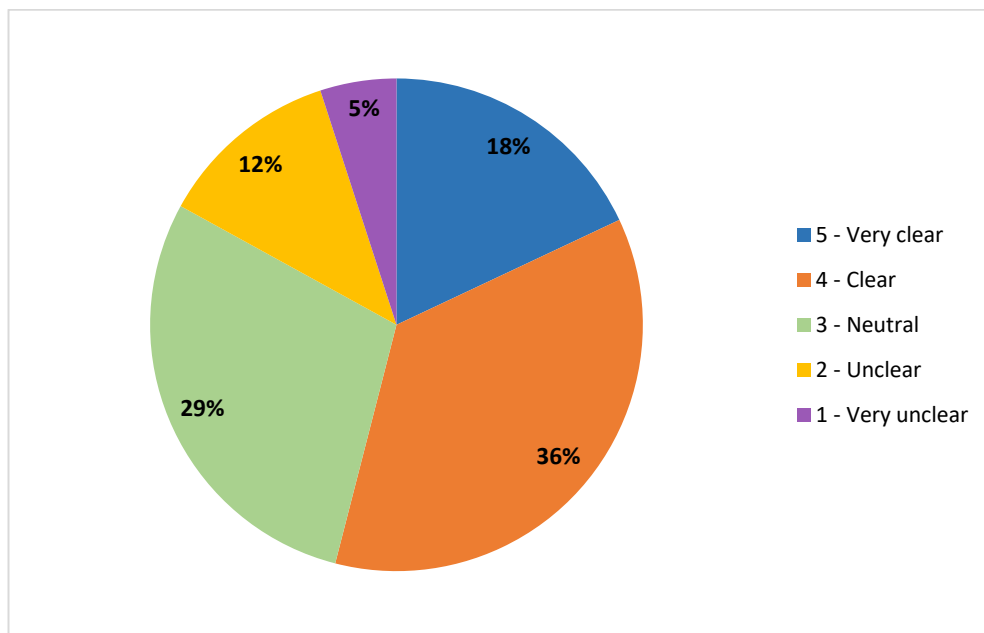


Interpretation: 58% of respondents rated the website or app as easy or very easy to use (ratings 4 and 5), while 26% were neutral. Only 16% found the interface difficult, suggesting that most e-commerce platforms provide a reasonably user-friendly digital experience. However, improving interface design for the 16% who struggle remains an important opportunity.

10. Is product information clear?

Clarity of Product Information

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
5 - Very clear	18	18%
4 - Clear	36	36%
3 - Neutral	29	29%
2 - Unclear	12	12%
1 - Very unclear	5	5%
Total	100	100%

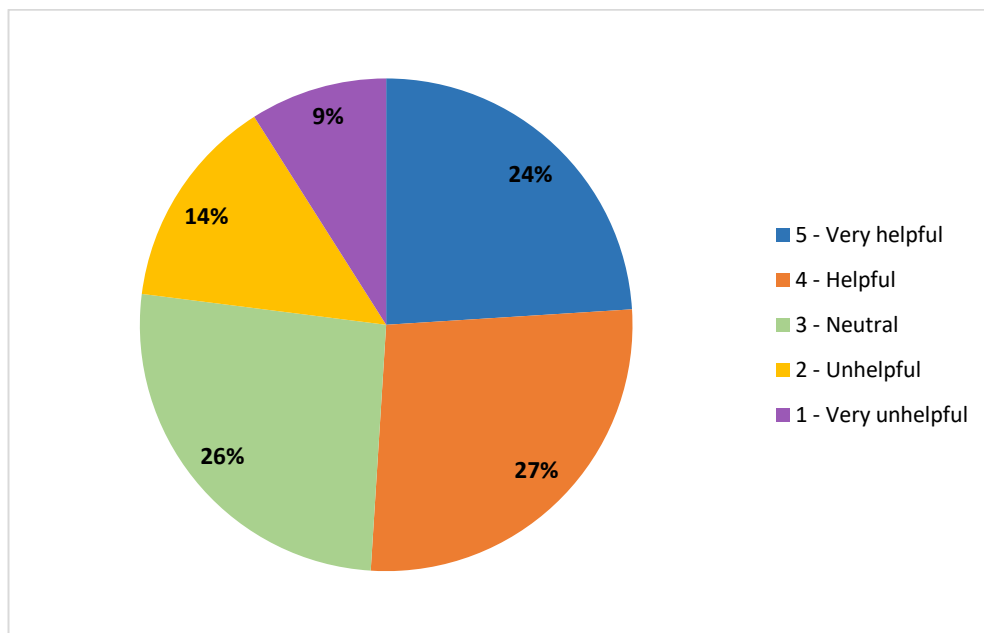


Interpretation: 54% of respondents found product information clear or very clear, while 29% were neutral and 17% found it unclear. Clear product information is essential for reducing return rates and improving customer experience. The relatively high neutral and negative responses indicate that product description quality and accuracy remain an area for improvement across e-commerce platforms.

11. Is customer support helpful?

Customer Support Helpfulness Rating

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
5 - Very helpful	24	24%
4 - Helpful	27	27%
3 - Neutral	26	26%
2 - Unhelpful	14	14%
1 - Very unhelpful	9	9%
Total	100	100%

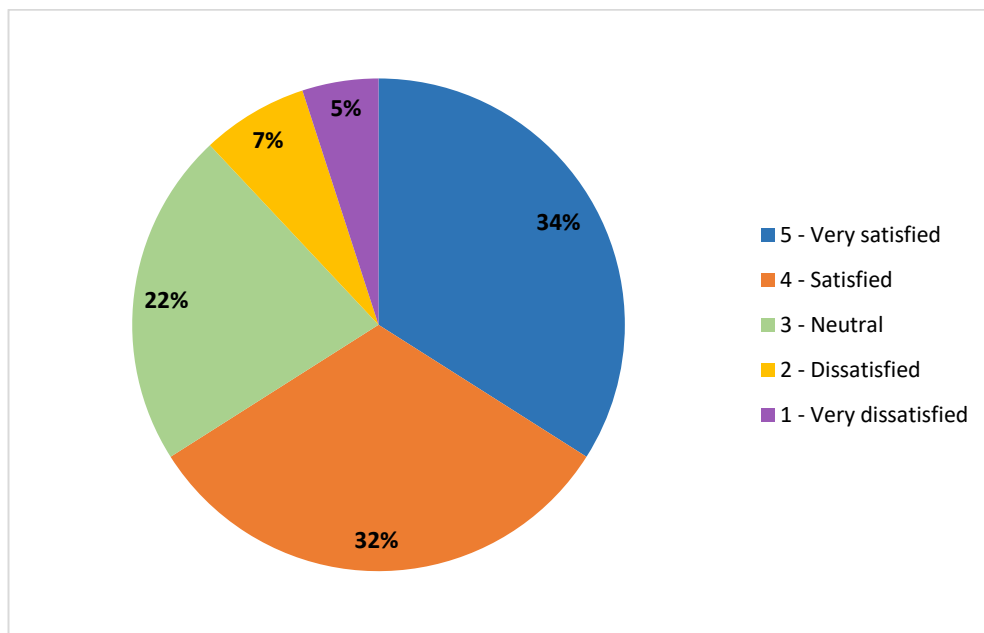


Interpretation: 51% of respondents rated customer support as helpful or very helpful, while 26% were neutral and 23% found it unhelpful. The relatively high proportion of dissatisfied customers highlights customer support as a critical area requiring investment and improvement for e-commerce companies focusing on enhancing the complete customer experience.

12. How satisfied are you with the delivery experience?

Delivery Experience Satisfaction Rating

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
5 - Very satisfied	34	34%
4 - Satisfied	32	32%
3 - Neutral	22	22%
2 - Dissatisfied	7	7%
1 - Very dissatisfied	5	5%
Total	100	100%

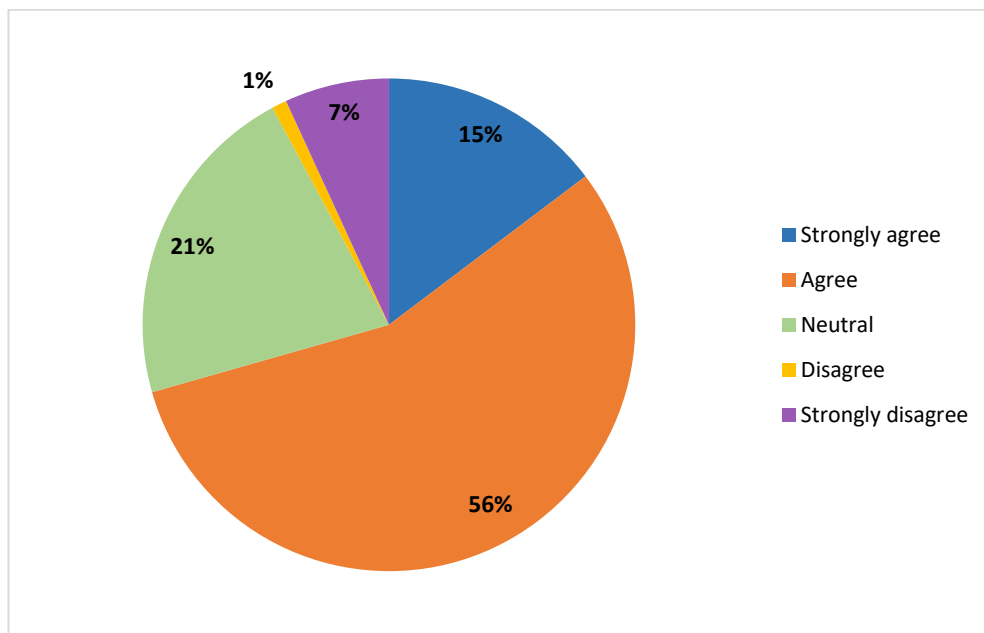


Interpretation: 66% of respondents rated their delivery experience as satisfactory or very satisfactory, with only 12% expressing dissatisfaction. The strong majority satisfaction rate reflects significant improvements in e-commerce logistics infrastructure in India. However, the 22% neutral response indicates that delivery experiences are inconsistent and further standardization is needed.

13. How smooth is the return/refund process?

Return/Refund Process Satisfaction

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly agree	15	15%
Agree	57	56%
Neutral	22	22%
Disagree	1	1%
Strongly disagree	7	7%
Total	102	100%

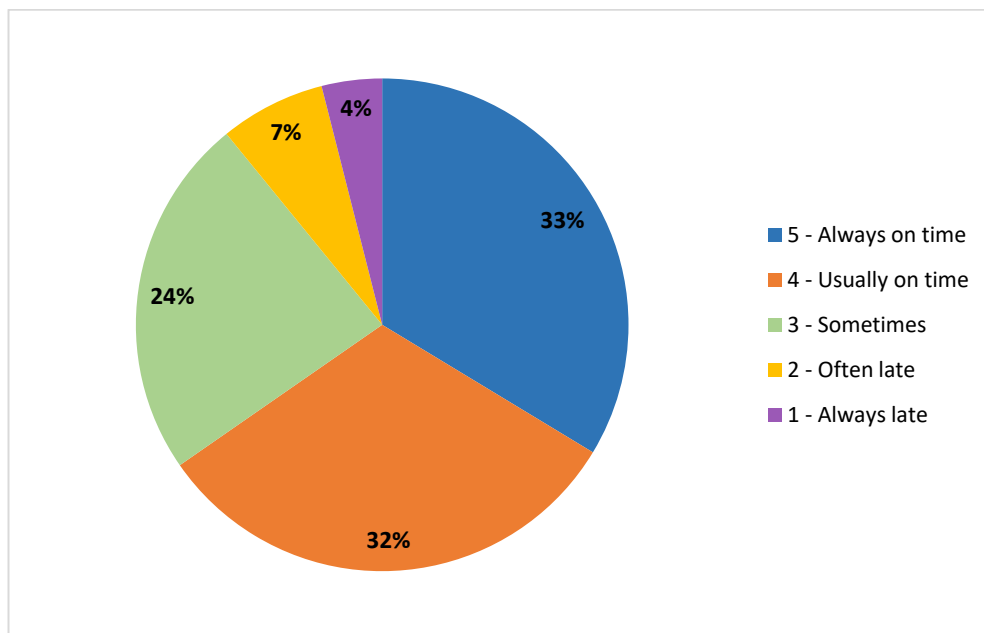


Interpretation: 71% of respondents agreed or strongly agreed that the return and refund process is smooth, while 22% were neutral and 8% disagreed. A smooth return process is a key driver of consumer trust and repeat purchasing. The majority positive response suggests that major e-commerce platforms have made meaningful progress in simplifying returns, though improvement is still needed for a significant minority.

14. Are orders delivered on time?

On-Time Delivery Rating

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
5 - Always on time	34	34%
4 - Usually on time	32	32%
3 - Sometimes	24	24%
2 - Often late	7	7%
1 - Always late	4	4%
Total	101	100%

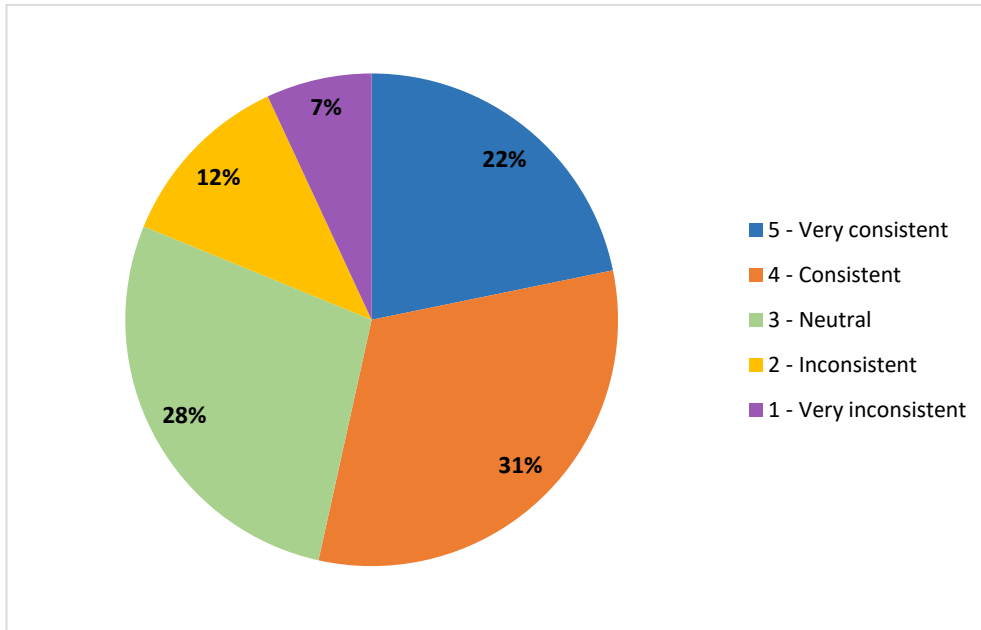


Interpretation: 66% of respondents rated on-time delivery at 4 or 5, indicating consistent timely delivery for the majority of consumers. 24% gave a neutral rating, while 11% reported frequent delays. These results clearly show that while delivery timeliness has improved significantly, last-mile delay challenges persist and require continued attention from e-commerce logistics teams.

15. Is product availability consistent?

Product Availability Consistency

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
5 - Very consistent	22	22%
4 - Consistent	32	32%
3 - Neutral	28	28%
2 - Inconsistent	12	12%
1 - Very inconsistent	7	7%
Total	101	100%

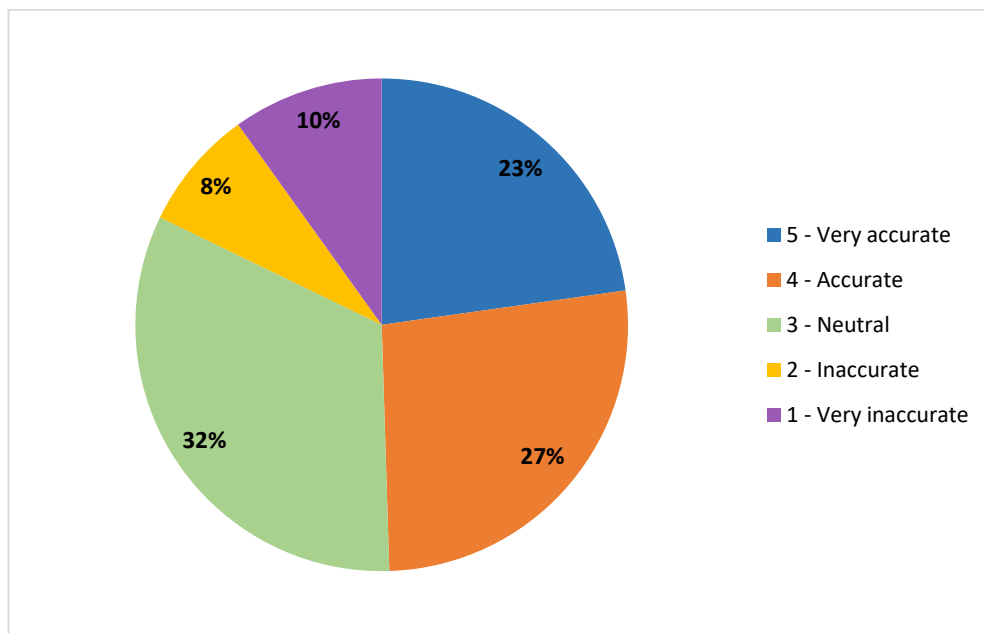


Interpretation: 54% of respondents found product availability to be consistent or very consistent, while 28% were neutral and 19% found it inconsistent. Consistent product availability is a fundamental supply chain requirement. The notable proportion of neutral and negative responses suggests inventory management and stock accuracy remain areas where e-commerce platforms need improvement.

16. Is order tracking accurate?

Order Tracking Accuracy Rating

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
5 - Very accurate	23	23%
4 - Accurate	27	27%
3 - Neutral	33	33%
2 - Inaccurate	8	8%
1 - Very inaccurate	10	10%
Total	101	100%

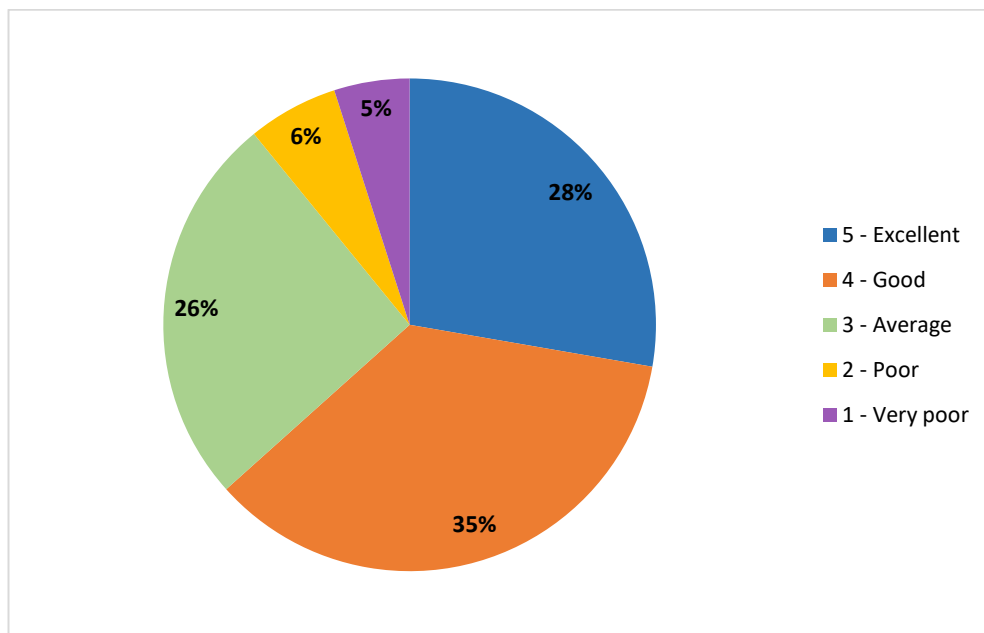


Interpretation: 50% of respondents rated order tracking as accurate or very accurate, while 33% were neutral and 18% found it inaccurate. Accurate order tracking is essential for managing customer expectations and reducing delivery anxiety. The high neutral and negative response rate suggests that tracking systems across e-commerce platforms there is still room for advancement in technology.

17. Is packaging quality good?

Packaging Quality Rating

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
5 - Excellent	28	28%
4 - Good	36	36%
3 - Average	26	26%
2 - Poor	6	6%
1 - Very poor	5	5%
Total	101	100%

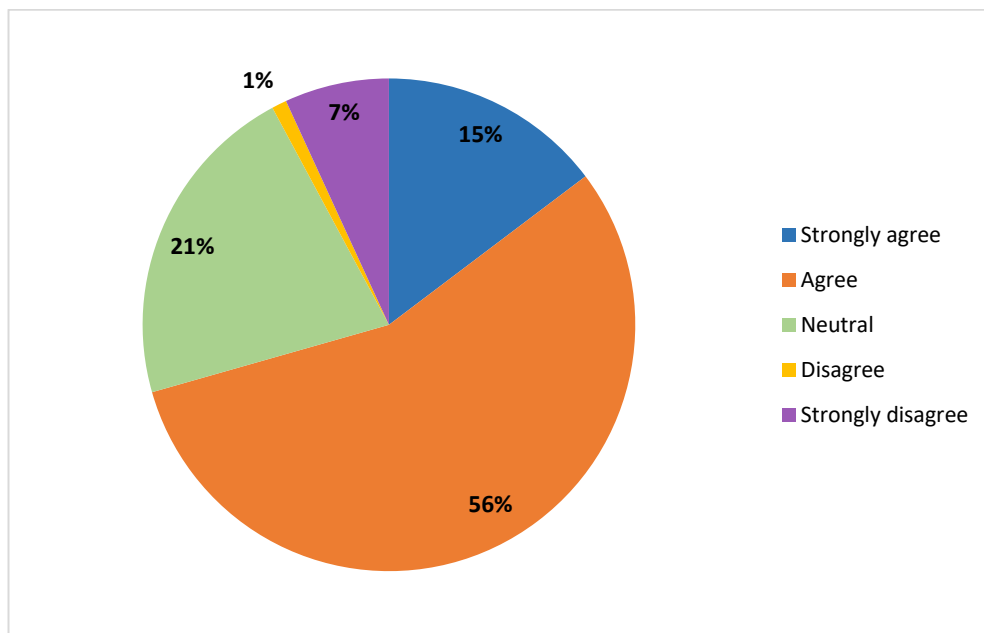


Interpretation: 64% of respondents rated packaging quality as good or excellent, while 26% considered it average and only 11% found it poor. Proper packaging does more than just keep products safe during transit but also contributes to overall brand perception and unboxing experience. The majority positive response indicates that e-commerce packaging standards have improved, though standardization across sellers remains a challenge.

18. Do delivery delays affect your satisfaction?

Impact of Delivery Delays on Satisfaction

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly agree	15	15%
Agree	57	56%
Neutral	22	22%
Disagree	1	1%
Strongly disagree	7	7%
Total	102	100%

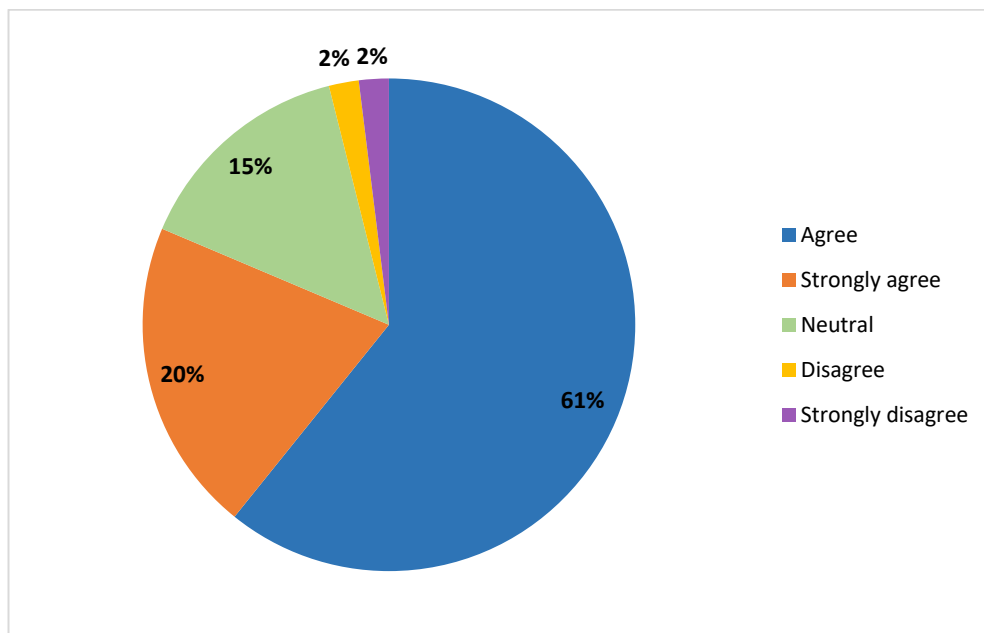


Interpretation: About 71% respondents indicated agreement or strong agreement that delays in delivery reduce their satisfaction, showing that on-time delivery is an important part of the overall customer experience. Only 8% of respondents disagreed, while 22% remained neutral. This result highlights the strong connection between supply chain performance and customer satisfaction in e-commerce.

19. Does digital marketing improve the shopping experience?

Digital Marketing Impact on Shopping Experience

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	62	61%
Strongly agree	21	21%
Neutral	15	15%
Disagree	2	2%
Strongly disagree	2	2%
Total	102	100%

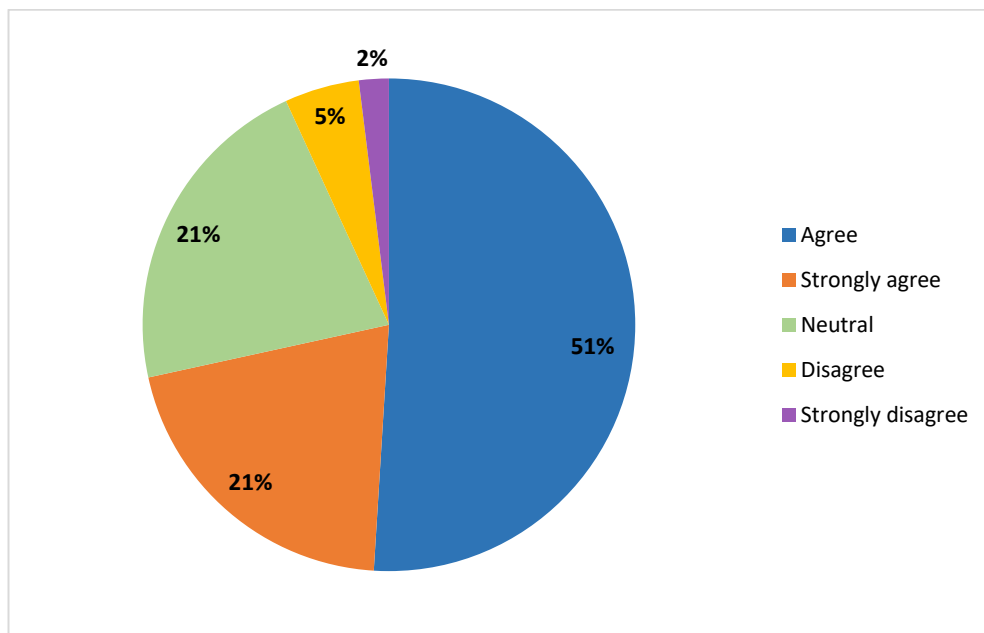


Interpretation: 82% of participants showed agreement or strong agreement that digital marketing improves the shopping experience, with only 4% disagreeing. This finding strongly validates the role of digital marketing in enhancing consumer engagement, product discovery, and overall shopping satisfaction. The broad consensus reflects the positive impact that well-executed how digital marketing shapes customer experience outcomes

20. Does better experience improve delivery perception?

Better Experience and Delivery Perception

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	52	51%
Strongly agree	21	21%
Neutral	22	22%
Disagree	5	5%
Strongly disagree	2	2%
Total	102	100%

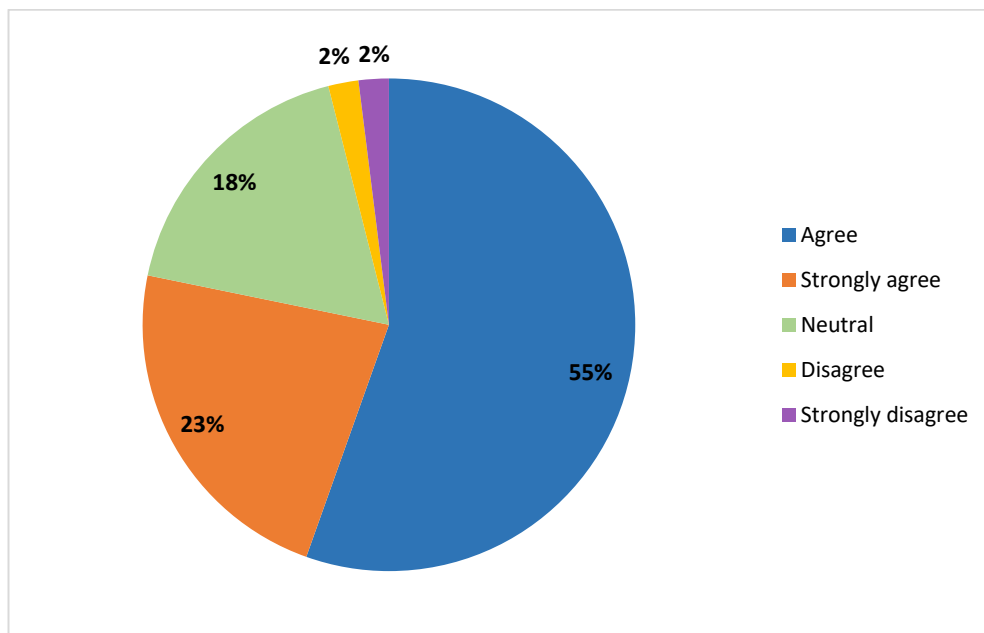


Interpretation: 72% of participants expressed agreement or strong agreement that a better overall shopping experience positively improves their perception of delivery services. This finding supports the role of customer experience as a connecting factor among digital marketing methods and supply chain performance, confirming that positive digital interactions create a halo effect that extends to how consumers evaluate delivery outcomes.

21. Does good experience increase trust?

Customer Experience and Trust Building

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	56	55%
Strongly agree	23	23%
Neutral	18	18%
Disagree	2	2%
Strongly disagree	2	2%
Total	101	100%

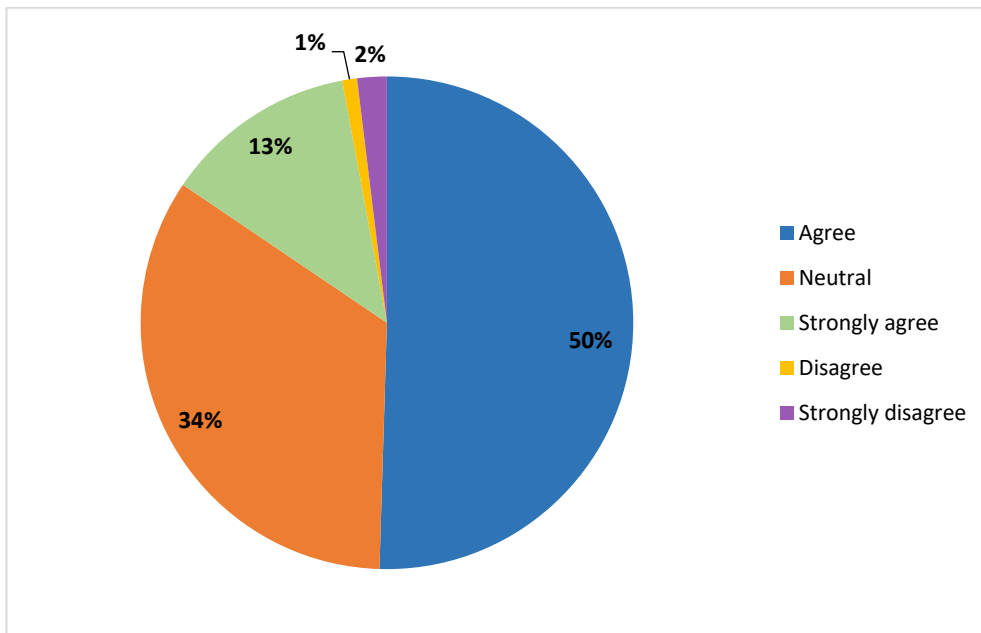


Interpretation: 78% participants confirmed agreement or strong agreement that a good customer experience increases trust in e-commerce platforms, where trust is an essential factor driver of repeat purchases and long-term customer loyalty. The results suggest that investing in superior customer experience is not just a marketing strategy but a foundational business practice for sustainable e-commerce growth.

22. Does customer experience affect supply chain perception?

Customer Experience and Supply Chain Perception

Response	No. of Respondents	Percentage
Agree	52	50%
Neutral	35	34%
Strongly agree	13	13%
Disagree	1	1%
Strongly disagree	2	2%
Total	103	100%



Interpretation: Customer experience shapes how people judge the supply chain, as many participants showed agreement or strong agreement, while 34% stayed neutral. This supports the study's main idea that customer experience links digital marketing efforts with supply chain performance. Positive experiences lead customers to form better opinions about supply chain operations.

4.2 Key Findings

From the analysis conducted of 102 responses collected through a structured Google Forms questionnaire, the following key findings were identified:

The study shows that social media is the dominant digital marketing channel for e-commerce, cited by 74% of respondents as their primary source of product advertisements. Despite this strong reach, 52% of participants gave a neutral response about whether digital ads directly influence their purchase decisions, suggesting that digital advertising works more through brand building and product awareness than direct conversion.

Customer experience acts as a strong a variable that connects digital marketing and supply chain performance. 82% of participants confirmed that digital marketing practices improves the shopping experience, 78% confirmed that good experience increases trust, and 63% agreed that customer experience directly affects their perception of supply chain performance. These three interconnected findings supply strong empirical support for the mediating role proposed in this study.

Supply chain performance indicators show generally positive but inconsistent results. 66% rated their delivery experience as satisfactory, 66% reported on-time delivery (rated 4 or 5), and 64% gave positive packaging ratings. However, order tracking accuracy received lower scores, with only 50% rating it as accurate, highlighting technology and communication problems in last-mile fulfilment that require rapid attention from e-commerce operators.

4.3 Summary of Data Analysis

The data collected from 102 respondents through a structured Google Forms questionnaire gives a comprehensive picture concerning the connection between digital marketing activities, customer experience, and the effectiveness of supply chain operations in Indian e-commerce.

The analysis consistently reveals that social media dominates the digital marketing field, with 74% of respondents encountering e-commerce advertisements mainly through social platforms. While digital advertising reaches a large audience, its direct influence on purchase decisions is moderate 52% remained neutral suggesting that customer experience, rather than advertising alone, is the primary driver of purchase behaviour.

the role of customer experience in connecting both variables is well supported by the data. The high agreement levels for statements linking digital marketing to shopping experience improvement (82%), good experience to trust building (78%), and customer experience to supply chain perception (63%) collectively confirm that customer experience functions as the critical link between marketing inputs and operational outcomes.

Supply chain performance is broadly satisfactory but uneven. Delivery satisfaction (66%), on-time delivery (66%), and packaging quality (64%) are relatively strong. However, order tracking accuracy (50% positive) and product availability consistency (54% positive) reveal operational gaps that, if addressed, might significantly improve the complete experience of the customer and supply chain performance.

5. FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

The results obtained in this study provide important useful understanding of the interrelated nature of digital marketing, customer experience, and supply chain efficiency in Indian e-commerce firms. The most fundamental finding is that digital marketing strategies and supply chain efficiency are not independent organizational functions they are deeply and dynamically connected through the medium of customer experience. Social media's dominance as an advertising channel (74%) means that the expectations created through social media marketing directly shape how consumers evaluate their delivery and fulfilment experiences. When social media campaigns create high expectations that supply chains cannot meet, customer satisfaction suffers and trust erodes.

The high agreement rates for experience-trust linkage (78%) and experience-supply chain perception linkage (63%) give clear data-based support for the role of customer experience as a connecting factor experience proposed in this study. Consumers who have positive digital marketing interactions form more positive opinions about the brand, which makes them more likely to forgiving of minor supply chain imperfections and more loyal over time.

The relatively weaker performance on order tracking accuracy (only 50% positive) is a particularly important finding. In a digital environment where consumers expect real-time information, poor tracking creates anxiety and displeasure that has the potential to undermine even excellent physical delivery performance. E-commerce firms must invest in transparent, accurate, and pre-emptive order communication systems to close this experience gap.

In general, the results indicate that e-commerce firms that correspond their digital marketing methods with their supply chain capabilities using customer experience as the bridge are more likely to build lasting customer loyalty and attain sustainable competitive advantage.

6. CONCLUSION

The findings of this study, drawn from 102 respondents through a structured Google Forms survey, offer strong proof that customer experience plays a critical mediating role between digital marketing strategies and supply chain performance in e-commerce firms.

The data shows that social media is the dominant digital marketing channel (74%), that 82% of consumers believe digital marketing improves their shopping experience, and that 78% agree that good experiences increase trust. These outcomes collectively confirm that digital marketing does not operate in isolation its effects flow through the customer experience to shape how consumers perceive and evaluate supply chain performance.

Supply chain performance data shows broadly positive but inconsistent results. While delivery satisfaction (66%) and on-time delivery ratings (66%) are encouraging, the weaker performance on order tracking accuracy (50%) and product availability consistency (54%) reveal operational gaps that, if left unaddressed, will undermine the positive customer experiences created through digital marketing investment.

The most actionable finding is that 63% of respondents confirmed that customer experience directly affects their supply chain perception, and 78% agreed that good experience creates trust. This places customer experience at the centre of e-commerce strategy not as a soft marketing concept but as a hard operational imperative that drives loyalty, repeat purchases, and supply chain effectiveness.

In conclusion, e-commerce firms must recognize that every digital marketing decision entails supply chain implications, and every supply chain action shapes the customer experience. Organizations that design their digital marketing and supply chain activities around a common commitment to superior customer experience will be the ones that earn lasting loyalty and preserve competitive advantage in an increasingly demanding digital market.

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